

PALEOZOIC CONIFER

Lebachia piniformis
A cone-bearing plant from Carboniferous and Permian strata, *Lebachia* is an ancestor of modern conifers.



CONIFER SEED CONES

Taxodium dubium
Found in Jurassic strata, *Taxodium* is related to modern cypress trees. It grew in damp habitats and had needle-like leaves.



COAST REDWOOD CONE

Sequoia dakotensis
Cones of the giant evergreen tree *Sequoia* have been found in Cretaceous and recent rocks. Some living members of *Sequoia* are over 2,000 years old.



CRETACEOUS CONIFER

Glyptostrobus sp.
This conifer grew in swamps during the Cretaceous Period and into the Cenozoic Era. *Glyptostrobus* was an important coal-forming tree.



SUBFOSSIL TREE RESIN

Kauri pine amber
Amber is the hardened resin from pine trees, such as Kauri pines. First occurring in the Early Cretaceous, it often contains fossils of insects that perished on the fragrant, sticky resin.

JURASSIC CONIFER

Araucaria mirabilis
This extinct species of monkey puzzle tree, *A. mirabilis*, bore characteristic female cones with spirally arranged scales attached to a central axis.

SECTION THROUGH CONE



CARBONIFEROUS GYMNOSPERM

Cordaite sp.
An ancestor of the conifers, *Cordaite* grew during the Carboniferous and Permian Periods. It was a tree-sized plant, which reproduced by seed.



GIGANTOPTERID LEAVES

Gigantopteris nicotianaefolia
A flowerless plant from Permian times, this species was so named because its leaves resembled those of tobacco plants.



PERMIAN GINKGO LEAVES

Psymophyllum multipartitum
Still found in China, ginkgos first appeared in the Permian Period. The fan-shaped leaves can be identified in fossils of *Psymophyllum*, a precursor of the modern-day ginkgo.



TRIASSIC GINKGO

Baiera munsteriana
Growing up to 15 cm (6 in) in length, the fan-shaped leaves of *Baiera* were split into separate ribs. In living ginkgos, the leaves are almost entire.



OAK TREE TRUNK

Quercus sp.
The well-known oak genus, *Quercus*, first occurs as fossils in Cretaceous strata. There are over 500 species of oak living today.

growth rings



STEMLESS PALM FRUIT

Nypa burtinii
Fossils of *Nypa* date from the Eocene Period onwards. This palm holds its woody seeds in a 25 cm (10 in) ball-shaped fruit.

MAGNOLIA LEAF

Magnolia longipetiolata
One of the earliest genera of flowering plants, magnolias first appeared in the Cretaceous Period. Early insects fed on their nectar.

